



IT ALL BEGAN WITH THE FORGING OF THE GREAT RINGS

THE LORD OF THE RINGS: THE FELLOWSHIP OF THE RING / 2001

IN CONTEXT

GENRE

Fantasy

DIRECTOR

Peter Jackson

WRITERS

Peter Jackson, Philippa Boyens, Fran Walsh (screenplay); J. R. R. Tolkien (novel)

STARS

Elijah Wood, Ian McKellen, Viggo Mortensen

BEFORE

1994 *Heavenly Creatures*, based on a notorious New Zealand murder case, brings Jackson critical prestige.

AFTER

2005 Jackson's box-office blockbuster *King Kong* is a remake of the 1933 classic.

2012–14 Jackson repeats the success of the *Lord of the Rings* trilogy with a three-part adaptation of J. R. R. Tolkien's novel *The Hobbit*.

Not since the biblical epics of Hollywood's classical era has a movie been made on the scale of *The Fellowship of the Ring*, the first installment in the *Lord of the Rings* trilogy. For many years, J. R. R. Tolkien's sprawling fantasy novel was considered to be unfilmable. Only with rapid advances in computer-generated imagery did the mythic locations, creatures, and vast battle scenes become a possibility for a movie director. However, although the movie fully

exploits its special effects, it does not depend on them. Its success owes far more to the skill of its director, Peter Jackson, who also cowrote the screenplay.

Jackson understood that he had to compress the intricate backstory as much as he could, keep the narrative pace fast, and maintain focus on the central character of Frodo Baggins (Elijah Wood). In doing so, he pulled off the notable feat of pleasing the



Much of the movie's critical and box-office success was due to Jackson's trimming of the plot, enhancing the action sequences, and expanding the female roles.

